

Investment Agent Operator Runbook

Version: August 2026 · v0.9.3 strategy account

Phase Gates · API Addendum (3a/3b/3c) · E*TRADE Developer Prep · Quick Reference

Print double-sided if desired. Dates are targets; criteria decide advancement.

Core principle: Advance only when **Go** criteria are met. Broker = financial truth (balances, positions, fills). Dashboard journal = synced copy + your intent (GO/NO-GO, proposal ID, reasoning).

1. Phase Gate Checklist

Phase 0 — September 2026 · Paper (Dashboard PAPER mode)

Your job: Daily operator — log what you would buy/sell; journal everything.

Gate	Go	No-Go
Daily use	≥20 trading days with entries (buy, sell, or explicit NO TRADE)	Skipping days without logging NO TRADE
Workflow	EOD review → next-day prep → pre-purchase check before each would-be entry	Trades logged after the fact without limits/times
Journal quality	Symbol, side, limit/stop/target, timestamp, fees, GO/NO-GO reason	Missing stops, targets, or rationale
Picker / ranking	Top tickets align with judgment ≥70% of days	Repeated wrong names at top
Risk gates	Kill switch, daily loss, deploy size respected in paper log	Repeated overrides undocumented
Metrics vs Plan	Track hit rate, hold time, gross vs Plan tab	No comparison to Plan assumptions
Exit discipline	Every open paper position has stop + target documented	Open-ended holds

Exit to Phase 1: All Go rows met and you trust the dashboard workflow.

Phase 1 — Q4 2026 · Live Manual (Dedicated E*TRADE ~\$15K)

Your job: Same analysis; **you** execute in a separate funded account; journal in LIVE mode.

Gate	Go	No-Go
Account isolation	Dedicated account; only agent strategy trades	Mixed personal + agent trades
Capital	~\$15K basis; deploy rules match Capital Builder	Oversized or idle cash drift
Execution	Limit entries; stop + profit target every live trade	Market-only entries without protection
Reconciliation	Weekly: broker statement ↔ journal	Unexplained cash/position gaps
Performance	≥8 weeks live; journal complete	<4 weeks or incomplete journal
Risk	No kill-switch breaches without post-mortem	Undocumented limit breaches
Fees	Actual commissions logged (~\$0 US stocks typical)	Modeled \$14 RT without note
Process	EOD + pre-market routine followed	Reactive trading without checklist

Exit to Phase 3a: Live journal trustworthy; ready for broker API read-only sync.

Phase 3 — Q1 2027+ · API Automation (3a → 3b → 3c)

3a — Read-only sync (broker → journal)

Gate	Go	No-Go
Auth	Stable daily session (renew/re-auth documented)	Silent auth failures
Balances	API cash/net liq matches broker within \$1	Persistent drift
Positions	API positions match broker 100%	Missing or stale holdings
Fills / transactions	Buys/sells auto-import with timestamps	Manual re-keying required
Mode	trading_mode=live; no API orders placed	Any accidental write

Exit to 3b: 2+ weeks clean daily sync.

3b — Write orders (human approves each proposal)

Gate	Go	No-Go
Proposal flow	Approve → preview → place → confirm fill	Direct place without preview
Exit policy	Entry + stop + target documented and tested	Stop/target left to memory
Idempotency	Duplicate-submit protection tested	Double orders on retry
Cancel	Can cancel working orders via API + dashboard	Stuck orphan orders
Kill switch	Blocks new API orders instantly	Orders fire when switch on

Exit to 3c: ≥20 approved API trades with zero unreconciled errors.

3c — Supervised full automation

Gate	Go	No-Go
Override	DO NOT TRADE halts new orders	Automation ignores override
Cancel all	Working stops/targets cancellable in one action	Orphan protective orders
Monitoring	Real-time order/position view in dashboard	Blind period after placement
Auth ops	Midnight / 2hr idle token handling automated (E*TRADE) or gateway stable (IBKR)	Morning failures with open risk
Rollback	Revert to 3b in <5 min	No downgrade path

Universal Stop Everything (all phases)

- ☐ Kill switch ON
- ☐ Cancel all working broker orders (Phase 3b/3c)
- ☐ Log incident + last known positions/cash
- ☐ Do not resume until root cause documented

2. API Operator Addendum (3a · 3b · 3c)

Scope: One dedicated strategy account. Broker = source of truth. Journal = intent + reconciliation.

A. Authentication checklist

E*TRADE (OAuth 1.0a)

Step	Action	Pass
A1	Register app; sandbox tested	Sandbox balance/positions pull OK
A2	Production keys stored securely	Not in git; secrets manager only
A3	User authorizes app (browser)	Access token obtained
A4	Same-day session	Renew if >2h idle (Renew Access Token API)
A5	Before midnight ET	Full re-auth required daily at midnight ET
A6	End of session / incident	Revoke access token
A7	Pre-flight each run	List Accounts → 200 OK

Daily (E*TRADE): Morning authorize if expired. Sync every 90 min or before any 3b place. EOD: optional revoke.

IBKR (Client Portal Gateway) — if chosen later

Step	Action	Pass
B1	Gateway installed & running	localhost:5000 reachable
B2	Login (live or DU paper)	Client login succeeds
B3	Portfolio session	/portfolio/accounts returns account
B4	Brokerage session (3b+)	/iserver/auth/status authenticated
B5	Order reply messages	Fat-finger prompts handled
B6	~1am local maintenance	No orders during outage window

B. Sync fields (3a — broker → journal)

Run **EOD** and **pre-market**; intraday after any manual broker action.

Field	Use
Account ID	Lock to single strategy account
Cash available / net account value	Deploy sizing, dashboard header
Unsettled cash	Block deploy if insufficient settled funds
Open positions	Symbol, qty, avg cost, market value
Open orders	Entry / stop / target working?
Transactions / trades	Auto-log buys/sells; epoch → local time
Fill price, qty, commission	P&L; replace modeled fees with actual
Order ID + status	Link journal ↔ broker

Reconciliation: Positions $\neq$ journal → MISMATCH flag, resolve same day. Never delete broker data.

C. Order lifecycle

C1 Proposal: Research → Risk gates → Proposal → APPROVE | REJECT | DO NOT TRADE

C2 Entry (3b/3c): E*TRADE: Preview → Place → poll fill → place STOP + LIMIT separately (no API bracket create). IBKR: bracket array in one POST.

C3 While open: Poll orders/positions. Partial fill → resize exits. Kill switch → no new entries; 3c cancels all working orders.

C4 Exit: Stop or target fills → cancel sibling. Manual sell → journal MANUAL OVERRIDE.

C5 Emergency: DO NOT TRADE → Kill ON → Cancel all → verify → reconcile before resume.

C6 Post-trade: Transaction in API → journal SYNCED. Update cash from balance API (read only).

D. Minimum log (every API touch)

Timestamp (UTC + ET) · Phase · Action · Proposal/journal ID · Broker order ID(s) · Result ·
Operator note if manual

3. E*TRADE Developer Prep (Steps A–D)

Official links — bookmark before 3a

Resource	URL
Getting Started	developer.etrade.com/getting-started
Developer Guides (OAuth + Sandbox)	developer.etrade.com/getting-started/developer-guides
Sample apps (Python/Java/Node)	developer.etrade.com/home
Sandbox key generator (logged in)	us.etrade.com/etx/ris/apikey
Sandbox API base	https://apisb.etrade.com/v1/...
Production API base	https://api.etrade.com/v1/...

Key types: Request **Individual** key (your account only). Vendor key = multi-user + Legal demo — not needed.

Sandbox: No real trades. Canned sample data. Tests OAuth + parsing only.

Step A — Sandbox (≈15 min · do anytime, even now)

- ☐ Log in to E*TRADE account (funding not required for sandbox)
- ☐ Open us.etrade.com/etx/ris/apikey → generate Sandbox consumer key + secret
- ☐ Store key/secret in password manager (not email, not repo)
- ☐ Download sample app from developer.etrade.com/home (Python recommended)
- ☐ Run OAuth against sandbox → confirm access token
- ☐ Call sandbox List Accounts → confirm JSON parses

Step B — Live / production key (~4–8 weeks before Phase 3a)

- ☐ Complete API User Intent Survey (personal automation, own account)
- ☐ Sign API Developer Agreement on Getting Started page
- ☐ Receive Individual Live consumer key + secret (immediate on page)
- ☐ Sign Market Data Agreement (required for quote API)
- ☐ Calendar: annual Market Data Attestation required thereafter

Step C — Before first production sync (3a)

- ☐ OAuth: manual verification code OR request callback URL via secure message (Technical Issues → E*TRADE API)
- ☐ Document token rules: renew if >2h idle; full re-login after midnight ET
- ☐ Point sync at dedicated strategy account only
- ☐ First production calls read-only: List Accounts → Balance → Positions → Transactions

Step D — Build-side prep (when agent implements 3a)

- ☐ Secure storage: consumer key, consumer secret, token secret
- ☐ OAuth HMAC-SHA1 signing (test vectors in Developer Guides)
- ☐ Config: sandbox vs production base URL

☐ Sync job uses fields from API Addendum Section B

Suggested timeline

When	Action
Now (Aug–Sep 2026)	Sandbox key + optional sample OAuth test
Sep 2026	Dashboard PAPER daily — no broker API
Oct 2026	Fund dedicated ~\$15K; manual live; cash account recommended
~Jan 2027 (before 3a)	Live Individual survey + agreement; read-only sync
Before 3b	Sandbox + cautious live Preview/Place tests

4. Quick Reference

Daily paper routine (September)

1. **EOD:** Review picks; log NO TRADE or would-have entries (limits, stops, targets).
2. **Pre-market:** Refresh watchlist; note gaps vs Plan.
3. **Pre-purchase:** Deploy size, risk gate, GO/NO-GO before any would-be buy.
4. **Weekly:** Compare paper results to Plan tab (hit rate, hold time, gross).

Manual trade pattern (Q4) — bracket equivalent

1. Limit buy at planned entry.
2. **On fill:** place GTC stop + GTC limit target for filled quantity.
3. Partial fill → stop/target for filled shares only.
4. One exit fills → cancel the other (OCO).

E*TRADE website supports brackets manually. API v0 requires separate stop + limit orders after fill.

PDT vs settlement (account type)

Topic	Cash account	Margin account
PDT rule	Does not apply	Applies if day trading same symbol same day
Same-day reuse of sale cash	Often blocked (T+1 settlement)	Buying power may allow; PDT if round-tripping
\$25K relevance	Not for PDT	Needed to day trade freely if flagged PDT
Your swing strategy	Recommended for Q4	Only if you need margin features

+\$10K injection (~month 6): Adds deploy capital; does not require day trading. PDT optimization is unnecessary for multi-day holds.

Account type: Cash ↔ Margin on E*TRADE

Direction	Possible?	How
Cash → Margin	Yes	Submit Margin Account Upgrade (in account settings or margin application PDF). Approval required; min ~\$2K equity.
Margin → Cash	Sometimes — not a one-click toggle	Contact E*TRADE; typically require zero margin debit, no short positions, settled balances. They remove margin feature on request.

Recommendation: Open dedicated strategy account as **cash** for Q4. Upgrade to margin later only if you deliberately need it (e.g. PDT headroom with \$25K+). Reverting to cash is possible but slower — plan account type up front.

September dashboard update (Mac)

```
cd ~/Home-Repository
git pull origin main
./scripts/hard_restart_dashboard_mac.sh
# Cmd+Shift+R in browser – expect v0.9.3
```


